

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century with novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for hungry 8th graders. Can be combined easily with Grades 11-12.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 2 times/week 30 min	Frankenstein Silas Marner Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass The Souls of Black Folk Up from Slavery Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 9-10



Frankenstein



Silas Marner



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



The Souls of Black Folk



Up from Slavery

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



General Lit.: Grades 9-10

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 1

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ INTRO

Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein* has had a continuous influence on the wider culture since its publication over two centuries ago. Sir Walter Scott pronounced it "extraordinary" and declared that Shelley possessed "uncommon powers of poetic imagination." The story has been told and retold through many adaptations and artistic forms; however, there is a disconnect between the cartoonish, green-faced Frankenstein monster familiar to most of us and Shelley's tale of a nameless monster created by Dr. Frankenstein. Karen Swallow Prior writes that the novel "is full of surprises for the first-time reader." Rather than a straightforward monster story, it is "in the strain of the philosophical novel. Readers expecting merely an entertaining tale of horror can expect to be confronted with big ideas and big questions" (14).

→ READ & NARRATE

p.1-7 "You will rejoice" - "my beloved sister!"

- Notice that the novel opens with a series of letters. There will be many narrative frames throughout the novel as characters tell stories within stories, so paying attention to the point of view is very important. What do you learn of Robert Walton from these opening pages?
- What tone is set by the opening line?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass OR Up From Slavery

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
- What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

Today, we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's *Narrative* contains several graphic descriptions of beatings and racial slurs.



Term 1

Ch.1 p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 3

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.8-14 "So strange an accident" - "and wrecked it - thus!"

- How are the gigantic creature and the stranger introduced? What questions do you have at this point in the novel?
- What are Walton's impressions of his guest? Why would Shelley introduce the title character to her readers through another character?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass OR Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 5

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.14-21 "I am by birth" - "the greatest avidity."

- Describe the circumstances of Victor's parentage, his childhood, and his education.



Term 1

- How does Victor recall his first reading of Agrippa? Does this foreshadow any of what is to come? Look for other instances of foreshadowing as you read.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass OR Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
- Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?